

An Act

ENROLLED HOUSE
BILL NO. 3076

By: Lepak of the House

and

Seifried of the Senate

An Act relating to teachers; amending 70 O.S. 2021, Section 6-133, as amended by Section 1, Chapter 349, O.S.L. 2023 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 6-133), which relates to new and innovative pathways toward teacher certification; expanding definition of provider; clarifying definition of program; replacing State Board of Education with Commission for Educational Quality and Accountability; striking pilot program language; requiring the Commission to initiate a request for information from potential providers; providing a timeline for the approval or denial of applications; requiring the Commission to provide notice for a denial and an opportunity to remedy deficiencies; directing the Commission to develop, promote, and coordinate a public awareness program; requiring the Commission to promulgate rules; amending 70 O.S. 2021, Section 6-122.3, as last amended by Section 162, Chapter 452, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 6-122.3), which relates to alternative placement teaching certificates; adding alternative teacher preparation programs to eligibility requirements; providing an effective date; and declaring an emergency.

SUBJECT: Teachers

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 6-133, as amended by Section 1, Chapter 349, O.S.L. 2023 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 6-133), is amended to read as follows:

Section 6-133. A. As used in this section:

1. "Provider" means an eligible school district, regional education service agency, institution of higher education, or other private or not-for-profit entity which is, or will be within three (3) years of being approved by the Commission for Educational Quality and Accountability, accredited by the Council for the Accreditation of Educator Preparation or the Association for Advancing Quality in Educator Preparation that seeks or has obtained approval of an alternative teacher preparation program consistent with this section; and

2. "Program" means an alternative teacher preparation program with content provided by a provider that leads toward teacher certification or licensure in a specific content area.

B. 1. The State Board of Education Commission for Educational Quality and Accountability shall identify providers to implement new and innovative pathways toward teacher certification on a pilot program basis through alternative teacher preparation programs. The Commission shall initiate a request for information from potential providers and shall provide eligible providers with information concerning the application process. Providers seeking to participate in the pilot program shall submit applications to the State Board of Education Commission. The Commission shall approve or deny an application within sixty (60) days of submission. If the Commission denies an application, the Commission shall provide notice with the reasons for the denial and permit the provider an opportunity to remedy the deficiencies.

2. The Commission for Educational Quality and Accountability shall develop, promote, and coordinate a public awareness program to be utilized in making potential teachers aware of approved providers and their programs. The State Board of Education shall post on its Internet website a list of approved providers, program requirements, and the cost of each program.

C. A provider ~~chosen~~ approved by the ~~State Board of Education~~ Commission for Educational Quality and Accountability shall offer a program that:

1. Provides evidence and history of fiscal solvency, capacity, operation, and program effectiveness;

2. Provides evidence of necessary infrastructure to provide accurate, timely, and secure data for the purpose of admission, teacher candidate monitoring, testing, and certification recommendations;

3. Has policies and procedures in place ensuring the security of teacher candidate records under applicable laws and regulations;

4. Has the instructional capacity within an existing novice teacher support program, the ability to obtain the instructional capacity, or has established a partnership with an accredited institution of higher education ~~institution~~ to provide adequate instruction in accordance with this subsection;

5. Offers an instructional phase that provides intensive preparation before the teacher candidates assume classroom responsibilities;

6. Offers a research-based and results-oriented approach focused on best teaching practices to increase student achievement and growth measured against state academic standards;

7. Provides assessment, supervision, and evaluation of teacher candidates to determine their specific needs throughout the program and to support efforts to successfully complete the program;

8. Provides intensive and ongoing professional development opportunities that accelerate a teacher candidate's professional growth, support student learning, and provide a workplace orientation, professional staff development, and mentoring;

9. Offers peer review focused on standards of professional practice and continuous professional growth; and

10. Provides a process to review a teacher candidate's final competency of required certification content standards that leads to a potential candidate being recommended for teacher certification in accordance with subsection F of this section.

D. ~~The State Board of Education~~ Commission for Educational Quality and Accountability shall ensure that providers ~~approved to participate in the pilot program~~ allow teacher candidates to demonstrate pedagogy and content standard proficiency in school-based programs and through other nontraditional means. Nontraditional means may include, but not be limited to, previous

work experience, teacher experience, educator evaluations, industry-recognized certifications, and other essentially equivalent demonstrations.

E. If the ~~State Board of Education~~ Commission determines that a provider fails to meet or is deficient in any of the requirements of this section including failing to become accredited by the Council for the Accreditation of Educator Preparation or the Association for Advancing Quality in Educator Preparation within three (3) years of the date of approval by the Commission, ~~it~~ the Commission may suspend or revoke the approval of the provider after providing notification of the deficiencies and an opportunity to remedy the deficiencies within a specified period of time as determined by the Commission.

F. A teacher candidate that completes a program offered by an approved provider shall be eligible for certification, provided he or she meets the certification requirements set forth in Section 6-187 of this title in the area of specialization for which certification is sought and is recommended for certification by the approved provider.

G. The State Board of Education shall issue a certificate to teach to any person who meets the requirements set forth in this section and who has on file with the Board a current Oklahoma criminal history record check from the Oklahoma State Bureau of Investigation as well as a national criminal history record check as defined in Section 150.9 of Title 74 of the Oklahoma Statutes. The person applying for the certificate shall be responsible for the cost of the criminal history record checks.

H. A provider shall submit a report to the ~~State Department of Education~~ Office of Educational Quality and Accountability after one (1) year of operation showing the percentage of teacher candidates who have completed the program and who have successfully completed or who have failed the competency examinations for certification and the provider's efforts to help candidates successfully pass the examinations. A provider shall annually submit a report to the ~~State Department of Education~~ Office of Educational Quality and Accountability outlining the success of the program.

I. The ~~State Board of Education~~ may Commission for Educational Quality and Accountability shall promulgate rules to implement the provisions of this section.

~~J. The pilot program created in this section shall end no later than July 1, 2026.~~

SECTION 2. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 6-122.3, as last amended by Section 162, Chapter 452, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 6-122.3), is amended to read as follows:

Section 6-122.3. A. The State Board of Education shall grant an alternative placement teaching certificate to a person who makes application to the Board and meets the following criteria:

1. a. holds at least a baccalaureate degree from an institution whose accreditation is recognized by the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education and has attained a retention grade point average of not less than 2.50 on a 4.0 scale, or
- b. has successfully completed a terminal degree, such as a doctorate of philosophy, a doctorate in education, professional doctorates, a master of fine arts degree or a master of library science degree, from an institution accredited by a national or regional accrediting agency which is recognized by the Secretary of the United States Department of Education. The Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education shall be consulted to verify other terminal degrees, or
- c. holds at least a baccalaureate degree from an institution whose accreditation is recognized by the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education and has qualified work experience in a field that corresponds to an area of certification as determined by the State Board of Education, and
- d. in addition to the requirements of subparagraphs a, b and c of this paragraph, has demonstrated competency or completed a major in a field that corresponds to an area of specialization for an Elementary-Secondary Certificate or a Secondary Certificate as determined by the State Board of Education or a vocational-technical certificate as recommended by the Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology Education;

2. Declares the intention to earn standard certification by means of an alternative placement program or an alternative teacher preparation program provided for in Section 6-133 of this title in not more than three (3) years. The State Board of Education shall determine the subject matter and the number of clock or semester hours required for the professional education component for each person making application for an alternative placement teaching certificate based on the criteria of paragraph 1 of this subsection.

The State Board of Education shall establish a core minimum of six (6) semester hours or ninety (90) clock hours and a maximum of eighteen (18) semester hours or two hundred seventy (270) clock hours for the professional education component.

The requirements set forth in this subsection shall exclude all student teaching requirements pursuant to the provisions of subsection E of this section;

3. Has passed the subject area portion of the competency examination required in Section 6-187 of this title in the area of specialization for which certification is sought; and

4. Either presents a document from an accredited public school district in this state offering employment in the area of specialization for which certification is sought on condition that the person enroll in an alternative placement program approved by the State Board of Education or declares the intention to seek employment as a teacher at an accredited public school district in this state. The certificate granted pursuant to this subsection shall be considered a "valid certificate of qualification" for the purposes of Sections 6-107 and 6-108 of this title, and the holder of the certificate shall be considered an inductee for the purposes of Section 6-195 of this title.

B. An alternative placement teaching certificate shall be renewed for not more than a maximum of three (3) years upon presentation of a document from an accredited public school district in this state offering renewed employment in the same area of specialization and a document from a teacher education institution verifying satisfactory progress in an appropriate alternative placement program.

C. Persons enrolled in an alternative placement program shall:

1. Have never been denied admittance to a teacher education program approved by the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education, the North Central Association of Colleges and Schools and by the Oklahoma Commission for Teacher Preparation to offer teacher education programs, nor have enrolled in and subsequently failed courses necessary to successfully meet the minimum requirements of the program, except those persons who hold a certificate;

2. Have on file with the director of teacher education at an Oklahoma institution of higher education a plan for meeting standard certification requirements within three (3) years; and

3. Participate in an induction program as required in Section 6-195 of this title and have the same duties and responsibilities as other inductees.

D. The State Board of Education may grant an exception to the requirements for certification and, upon demonstration by an individual of specific competency in the subject area of specialization, may grant a certificate to the individual. The State Board may establish other requirements necessary to grant exceptions.

E. The State Board of Education, in consultation with the Commission for Educational Quality and Accountability, may grant an exception to the requirement to complete a subject area examination for initial certification in a field which does not require an advanced degree pursuant to this section if the candidate has an advanced degree in a subject that is substantially comparable to the content assessed on a subject area examination. The degree shall be from an institution accredited by a national or regional accrediting agency which is recognized by the Secretary of the U.S. Department of Education. The Commission shall provide the Board with the necessary information to determine comparability.

F. Student teaching and a prestudent teaching field experience shall not be required of alternative placement program participants for standard certification.

G. The State Board of Education shall promulgate rules authorizing adjunct teachers who shall be persons with distinguished qualifications in their field. Adjunct teachers shall not be required to meet standard certification. A person employed as an adjunct teacher pursuant to this subsection who does not hold a

valid certificate to teach shall not be considered a teacher as defined by Section 1-116 of this title.

H. Each teacher education institution shall provide the Oklahoma Commission for Teacher Preparation an annual report of information as specified by the Commission regarding participation in the alternative placement programs offered by the institution.

I. The Oklahoma Commission for Teacher Preparation shall not accredit, renew the accreditation of, or otherwise approve any teacher education program of any institution of higher education in this state that has not implemented alternative placement programs in at least four areas of specialization including mathematics, science and a foreign language. Each institution shall allow individuals who meet the criteria of subsections A and C of this section to be:

1. Admitted to an alternative placement program without further qualification; and

2. Offered the opportunity to complete the requirements for standard certification set forth in subsection A of this section during the summer preceding and the summer following the first year of teaching with an alternative placement teaching certificate. Any person seeking standard certification through an alternative placement program shall be permitted to take necessary courses during regular semesters if offered.

J. The criteria specified in subsection I of this section can be met through a cooperative arrangement entered into by two or more institutions of higher education.

SECTION 3. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

SECTION 4. It being immediately necessary for the preservation of the public peace, health or safety, an emergency is hereby declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

Passed the House of Representatives the 11th day of March, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the House
of Representatives

Passed the Senate the 4th day of May, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the Senate

OFFICE OF THE GOVERNOR

Received by the Office of the Governor this _____
day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.
By: _____

Approved by the Governor of the State of Oklahoma this _____
day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

Governor of the State of Oklahoma

OFFICE OF THE SECRETARY OF STATE

Received by the Office of the Secretary of State this _____
day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.
By: _____